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IN TOUCH WITH SELF
An online puja in Noida being performed based upon the client's specific requirements

the prayer, with a negotiable *dakshina* given to the priest. The demand has pushed the platform to simplify the first layer of astrological interpretation. "We built a personalised AI astrologer, which helps users understand their birth chart and which *puja* may suit them, in simple language," says Shukla. "Instead of waiting for an appointment with an astrologer, users can enter their birth details and receive an instant interpretation of their *kundli*, planetary placements and possible recommendations."

For Ananya Sen, 27, a homemaker in Noida, this service became particularly useful when she and her husband were trying to decide on an auspicious date to move into their

FROM AI TO AARTI

HOW PERSONALISED PRAYERS WORK

START WITH AI

Enter your birth date, time and place. An AI astrologer can map the *kundli* (maps of celestial positions at the time and place of one's birth), identify the *dasha* (current celestial position) and suggest areas that may need attention

MATCH THE CONCERN

The consultation may focus on careers, money, marriage, health, legal matters, property, relocation, fertility or a major purchase

DECODE THE CHART

The emphasis may fall on Saturn for work and delays, Venus for relationships, Jupiter for growth and prosperity, Mercury for communication or Mars for conflict

CHOOSE A SPECIALISED RITUAL

Options can include *Navagraha Shanti* (to pacify celestial influences), *Pitru Dosh Puja* (looking for faults in one's lineage), *Chandi Homa* (a ritual to remove obstacles, dedicated to Goddess Durga), and more

CUSTOMISE THE RITUAL

The prayer may be timed to a specific *muhurat* (ideal period), linked to a *graha dasha* (unfavourable planetary combination), include a personalised *sankalp* (intention for the prayer) or be performed at a temple associated with that deity or planetary remedy

PERFORM IT ANYWHERE

It can happen at home, in a temple, at a pilgrimage site or over live video from another city. Time can vary. A simple personalised prayer may take about an hour, while ancestral rites or multi-stage rituals can run for six to eight hours or more